

Activity 8 — Role-Play Observer Checklist

Service Recovery Under Pressure — The Wedding Catering Failure

Focus of this observation	Service recovery — HEARD, unconditional apology, limits and root-cause fix
You are observing	Role A — the Duty Manager
Setup	Pairs or trios. A = Duty Manager, B = Mr Wong, C = observer scoring against HEARD.
Duration	15 minutes

Observer: _____ Performer: _____ Round: 1 / 2

Tick **DONE** only where you actually saw the behaviour. 'What good looks like' is the standard — anything less is **NOT YET**.

Cod e	What to observe	What good looks like	Done	Not yet
A3	HEAR — let the customer finish	Allowed the photographs and the full account, however long. Note the time of the first interruption; inside 90 seconds is the common failure.		
A3	EMPATHIZE — named the actual loss	The vegetarian guests with nothing to eat, the 35-minute delay in front of 200 people, the damaged cake. Generic 'I understand your frustration' scores zero.		
A3	APOLOGIZE — unconditional	No 'if', no 'but', no 'however', no blaming the kitchen. Circle any conditional word used.		
A3	RESOLVE — concrete and immediate	Stated the 40% refund as already authorised, and committed to taking the balance to the Director today with a callback time.		
A3	DIAGNOSE — explained the cause and the fix	Named the run-sheet process gap and that it is being closed.		
K1	Established common ground before setting the limit	'We both want this made right' — turned an adversarial exchange into a shared problem.		
K1	Set the limit once, without haggling	Did not repeat or defend the 40%; restated the escalation path instead.		
A3	Produced a written process fix with an owner	A specific system or procedural change, owned, plus how Mr Wong will be told what changed.		

Strongest moment — what worked, and why

One thing to change in the next round

The performer's own view (ask them first, before you give feedback)

Check your work: All five HEARD stages were delivered, your apology contained no conditional words, you set the 40% limit once without haggling, and you produced a written process fix with an owner.